

VETERAN ENTREPRENEURSHIP ONE-DAY

VIRTUAL WORKSHOP

LOCATION: Teams

ACCESS LINK: [Click Here to Join the Meeting](#)

DATE: Monday, February 23, 2026

GOALS & OBJECTIVES

1. To assist participants in understanding the steps, stages, and activities related to launching and growing a business as a post-military career.
2. To help participants understand how business ownership might align (or not) with their own personal strength and life goals.
3. To provide introductory training and orientation to the fundamental tools and strategies associated with executing on plans to launch a new business.

SBA Houston Local Resources

SBA Houston District Office - <https://www.sba.gov/tx/houston>

Veterans Business Outreach Center - <https://www.utrgv.edu/vboc/>

Houston SBDC - <https://www.sbdc.uh.edu/sbdc/default.asp>

SCORE Houston - <https://houston.score.org/>

Alliance Women's Business Center - <http://www.wbea-texas.org/alliwbc-1#>

WBEA Women's Business Center - <https://www.wbea-texas.org/wbea-wbc-core#>

GHWCC Women's Business Center - <https://ghwcc.org/entrepreneurs/>

SBA Contact

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SBA Houston District Office

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VBOC Contact

David Medrano

Business Advisor

UTRGV Veteran Business Outreach Center

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BOOTS TO BUSINESS REBOOT AGENDA

TIME	AGENDA ITEM
8:00am-8:15am CT	WELCOME AND INTRODUCTIONS OBJECTIVE: Provide an overview of the Boots to Business program, the 2-day workshop, and Introduction to Feasibility Analysis. • David Medrano – Business Advisor, UTRGV Veterans Business Outreach Center
8:15am-9:05am CT	TRAINING MODULE 1: INTRODUCTION TO BUSINESS OWNERSHIP OBJECTIVE: Provide an overview of the entrepreneurial process, what it means to be an entrepreneur, the opportunities and challenges and military skills and attributes that transfer over to entrepreneurship. • Richard Ashe – Veteran Franchise Advisers
9:05am-9:30am CT	MODULE 1a: Franchise Opportunities for Veterans • Richard Ashe – Veteran Franchise Advisers
9:30am-9:40am CT	BREAK
9:40am-10:30am CT	TRAINING MODULE 2: BASICS OF OPPORTUNITY RECOGNITION OBJECTIVE: Describe the process and activities related to understanding the ‘business case’ for turning an idea into a sustainable business concept. • Kim Way – Director, Houston Center SBDC
10:30am-11:20am CT	TRAINING MODULE 3: UNDERSTANDING MARKETS & YOUR COMPETITIVE SPACE OBJECTIVE: Understand how to conduct market research, the importance of market research, and the basics of competitive strategy/analysis. • Elizabeth Charles – Veteran Business Development Officer, SBA Houston
11:20am-12:10pm CT	TRAINING MODULE 4: THE ECONOMICS OF SMALL BUSINESS START-UP OBJECTIVE: Understand the foundation for the cost, price, volume relationship, as it informs profit potential and sustainability for the planned venture. • Sharita Humphrey – CEO, Change in Motion LLC
12:10pm-1:10pm CT	LUNCH
1:10pm-2:00pm CT	MODULE 5: LEGAL CONSIDERATIONS FOR VETERAN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESSES OBJECTIVE: Understand the various legal forms of a business; opportunities and challenges associated with each; offer an overview of other legal considerations impacting veteran-owned business; government contracting. • Rita Leader – Business Mentor, SCORE Houston
2:00pm-2:50pm CT	MODULE 6: INTRODUCTION TO BUSINESS PLANNING OBJECTIVE: Understand the concepts and value of business planning and utilize SBA Resource Partners and tools to develop a viable business plan. • Doug Sewell – Business Mentor, SCORE Houston

2:50pm-3:00pm CT	BREAK
3:00pm-3:50pm CT	MODULE 7: FINANCING YOUR VENTURE OBJECTIVE: Understand what types of financing are available for your business; understand the difference between debt & equity financing; and explore what lenders and investors look for when deciding whether to finance your small business. • Winston Labbé – Deputy District Director, SBA Houston
3:50pm-4:20pm CT	MODULE 8: RESOURCES TO SUPPORT YOUR EFFORTS OBJECTIVE: Understand the resources available through the SBA, VA, and other resource partners positioned to provide future training and support of the participant’s efforts to launch and grow a sustainable business venture. • Elizabeth Charles – Veteran Business Development Officer, SBA Houston • David Medrano – Business Advisor, UTRGV Veterans Business Outreach Center
4:20pm-4:45pm CT	GROUP QUESTION/ANSWER SESSION/CLOSING REMARKS

BOOTS TO BUSINESS FOLLOW-UP

ONLINE TRAINING:

B2B Revenue Readiness from MSU: Six-week virtual training program, using an interactive classroom with a “live” instructor that meets twice a week. Designed to help participants take a business idea from concept to actionable plan in a relatively short timeframe, B2B RR helps participants focus on identifying and understanding customers, developing a business model, and drafting a business plan.

Building on the knowledge gained in the introductory two-day B2B course, the follow-on program is designed to meet you wherever you are in your entrepreneurial journey whether you’re ready to launch, need further insight on business fundamentals, or even desire industry-specific training.

To sign up, visit <https://sba.my.site.com/s/>, and check the **Calendar** or **Class List** section for upcoming *Revenue Readiness* courses. You can also email SBA’s Boots to Business team at boots-to-business@sba.gov, or call us toll-free at 844-610-VET1 (8381).

To be eligible to register for B2B Revenue Readiness, participant must have completed a B2B or Reboot course and have a profile on the B2B Community Portal. [Click Here to Login or to create your profile.](#)

SBA’s Online Learning Center: Free training for Starting or Managing a Business, Marketing, Financing, or Government Contracting, available 24/7 at: <https://www.sba.gov/sba-learning-platform>

One-On-One Mentoring and Other Support: Find the nearest SBA resources in your area: <https://www.sba.gov/local>